Operations Manager

Operations Role

Goals

- To increase capacity and in turn increase gross profit with a sustainable structure so that the business can grow
- To improve the customer journey and satisfaction through improved internal processes and procedures
- To improve internal team motivation and engagement through the improved processes and procedures.
- As a result of the process improvements it is key that we instill an ethos across the business of Quality, Responsiveness and Flexibility across the business (UK and India.

Business Objective

The aim of the business is to grow turnover by 200% in the next 2 years and to achieve an average gross profit margin of 60% across all projects (interior and exterior CGI's) through production and process efficiencies.

Role

The role will be focused in and around observing and reviewing the operational matters that have been identified in the business that need addressing and then working on solutions as to how we can best improve through to implementation and monitoring of those solutions. It is anticipated that the process of developing the solutions and implementing those into the business could take up to 6 months to achieve and indeed some will be ongoing following that.

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At the end of this document is a general description of what the Operational Manager role would cover however the finer details of this role will need to be

fleshed out as we go through this process as it will also be greatly impacted by this process we are looking to undertake.

How will the role work?

- Working with the Directors to agree what operational issues need to be addressed
- Working with the Directors to come up with the ideas / solutions to address the operational issues. Inputs and collaboration with Operations Manager in India on a number of areas will also be required.
- Working with the Directors to agree a timeline for implementing the solutions

The Directors will give you as much support as necessary to get the change to happen in the business. We would also want a regular status update meeting with the Directors to discuss progress. We can agree the frequency.

Considerations

All ideas that are generated must also have a sense check on affordability to the business. It is important that a cost vs benefit analysis of any initiative that will have a financial impact on the business is carried out. If the initiative is deemed to be worthwhile but not financially viable / affordable in the short to medium term, a suggestion of what needs to happen in the business along with a timetable in order to enable this to happen.

There will need to be some consideration on flexibility in what this role covers as the business is looking to change which means there will be some flux and will require you to wear different hats at times. We are also a small business and things can unexpectedly happen which may also divert focus for a time.

If it also imperative that throughout the process that there is a stay positive and focused approach and along with the Directors put up a unified front to

the whole team. It is also key that this is translated into a positive atmosphere throughout the business.

The following are some areas the Directors have identified that need to be addressed and we would welcome your thoughts on these and any additions. The list is in no particular order.

PRODUCTION

Production Management

Creating a system that will maximise operational efficiency of the India Production team, with consideration to workflow from the UK.

We need to look at how clients are handled and the client journey / process that will enable this to

happen right through to how work (new work and amends) are booked into production to make sure we have as few gaps as possible in our workload. Taking into account peaks and troughs.

This will need to be looked at from the India point of view and how we book work into the team, how clients are asked to book work in and how we schedule work. Also working in conjunction with the Operations Manager in UK (to be appointed in lieu and will be in conjunction with the UK Director) to create a process to maximise operational efficiency for the work completed in India.

What internal systems and procedures need to be set up and in place to handle peaks and troughs in workflow for production. How will this affect Account Management? As above, will the project co-ordinator / producer role work better to support the production process? If need to re-employ, what would the job spec of that person be, what level would they be and what salary? Also, what time benefits will be brought about through a new project management system?

Production Efficiency

Working with the production teams and in particular the senior team members to look at how and if we can reduce production times on image production (exteriors and interiors). If efficiencies can be made, this will enable the business to increase gross profit margin.

Project Management System

Identification of an end to end project management system or development of the current system into a more efficient process. If the favoured option is for new software, we need to know and understand the benefits of such a system for production, account management and sales. The goal would be for us to have a system in place that will save work, increase efficiency and easily provide management information / data / metrics. There will need to be a cost vs benefit case for any system that is finally selected.

Once a system has been agreed upon, you will be working closely with the UK Operations Manager / Director to ensure that the software or new processes (if it is favoured that existing systems are further developed) are swiftly and successfully implemented across the business.

If the new system will impact how the business works with and operates with its clients, you will need to work with the client teams in creating a processes and procedure that is rolled out to clients. For example, (using Workbook for this instance), the way quotations are produced and sent will change from how they are currently done and the way amends / feedback via the online proofing system are made will also need to be considered in the client journey. All aspects of how a new system will impact the way we work with the different sets of clients we have will need to be considered.

In order to get an understanding of how the roll out will benefit the business, benchmarks will need to be created for how long the current process take to work with and what efficiencies in the process we hope to achieve with the

implantation of the new system. This may also have an impact on the people resource needs for certain parts of the business.

Once the system has been implemented across the business, ongoing monitoring will be required to ensure that the agreed processes and procedures of system usage are adhered to by the India team and working with the Operations Manager / Director in the UK to ensure that this also happens in the UK. Further to this, you will also be required to undertake regular reviews with key stakeholders within the business to see if the current processes and procedures of the project management system can be improved and developed upon.

KPI's

A set of KPI's needs to be developed for the account handling team and artists. The KPI's for both account handling teams and artists needs to be motivating but also challenging so that they feel they have something to strive for and work towards. - see attached.

Operational Structure & Roles

Current Structure

Does the current operational structure need to change? Review the structure, all roles and positions within the India team and look at what kind of structure and positions would work best for the business. It will be important to ensure that the wider team in UK is also considered. Also consider how this may impact the structure and workflow coming from UK and suggest options if this would need to change in order to align both operations.

In order to achieve this, it will require you to look at what is best for the business but also what is practice in our industry and research how the structures of other similar creative agencies work. For example, how the

production co-ordinator (producer), what is the job role be on a day to day basis? Where would their role start and end in the production process and how this would interface with the account handling team as to where do their responsibilities start and where do they end? In turn, how this would affect the work that the account handling team do and therefore what the focus of their role will be? Should some of the role be undertaken in the UK or can it all be done in India. Could this be for both interiors and exteriors or both?

New Opportunities

Create a structure that allows some time for R&D into new ideas, business sectors, new techniques and development of those into our workflow. This will require you to work with the Lead Artist who will drive the new techniques based ideas and also working the Operations Manager / Director in the UK for their input.

Styling

How do we make the moodboard design process profitable from a production standpoint? At the moment the level of business generated from interiors doesn't make it profitable to have someone full time. What other responsibilities need to be undertaken by the stylist to cover the cost of having someone in this role? What would this role look like? How much capacity does one person styling have? A full job description with roles and responsibilities would need to be drawn up around this so that there is clarity. Can this role be done within India or would it require to be done in the UK? Where would it be financially viable vs skill set?

Learnings

Create a system where a selection of projects are de-briefed on a regular basis and learnings applied to the business. The system needs to be robust so that actions decided as a result of the review are implemented into the workflow / procedures of the business.

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Team

Development of Artists

Working with Lead artist, Studio Manager, Production Coordinator and with the Operations Manager in UK look at ways we can create opportunities to train and develop junior artists in the UK and India. Also plan for the career development of artists.

Training and Development

Review the training and development needs of the team that will help them develop and do their jobs better.

Staff Reviews / Appraisals

Working with the Directors to identify and implement the best / most suitable staff review / appraisal process for the India team.

Team incentives / Engagement

Working with the directors to review options for creating incentives across the team to reward good performance linked to the performance of the business. Also looking at ways that team engagement levels can be improved.

New Starters

Working with the Directors to come up with a Welcome pack for new staff / starters that is precise and concise.

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Additional Processes and Procedures

- Working with the India Studio Manager and UK Lead Artists to review the introduction of a new production pipeline where artists take on smaller parts of jobs based upon their skills e.g. modelling, texturing and lighting as specific tasks allocated to different artists on the same project.
- Working with the India Studio Manager and UK Lead Artists to create an overview of 'best practice' for artists that can be passed on to freelancers.
- Assisting the business in creating a culture of short but engaged meetings.

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General

- Monitoring of all 'Live' projects and regular reporting on the status of those projects with relevant team members to ensure that potential project overruns are flagged up early and remedial measures can be taken.
- Assist with any recruitment where necessary.

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- Provide inspired leadership for the organization.
- Help promote a company culture that encourages top performance and high morale.
- New techniques, workflow and software testing and implementation.
- Develop, implement and review operational policies and procedures.
- Planning and supporting quality process.
- Support worker communication with the management team including communication between India and UK studio.
- Provide progress log to each member of staff.
- Manage and direct operations team to achieve business targets.
- 'Provide monthly studio performance report' (this will include actual vs estimated on projects, down time on projects, performance of artists within the team and other KPI's that will help us understand how the studio is performing).
- Oversee staff review process and ensure all paperwork related to it is up to date and on track.
- Organize implement and conduct Training and development sessions keeping a training and development log for each person.
- Directly responsible for increasing production levels.
- Make important policy, planning, and strategy decisions in conjunction with stakeholders and ensure they are implemented.
- Updating stakeholders holders on regular basis through “bi monthly” project progress reports - Submit collective monthly report showing all efforts/innovations putted in a particular month. Inputs will be taken from the Studio Managers reports.

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- Work with the stake stakeholders to determine values and mission, and plan for short and long-term goals.
- Work with senior stakeholders to achieve goals and format direction.
- Build alliances and partnerships with other organizations for outsourcing requirements.
- Develop Account Management KPIs in conjunction with UK Operational Manager.
- Develop Artist's KPIs in conjunction with Studio Manager.
- Coordinating the development of user manuals, training materials and other documents as needed to enable successful implementation and turnover of the process or system to the clients in conjunction with relevant stakeholders
- Assist HR with recruiting, interviewing and in conjunction with the Office manager train candidates.
- Leave to be managed so it doesn't clash with studio manager so that a member of management is always available. Handovers should be clear, detailed and precise.
- Identify and address problems and opportunities for the company.
- Oversee budgeting, reporting, planning, and auditing.
- Ensure all legal and regulatory documents are filed and monitor compliance with laws and regulations.
- Conduct Bi-monthly, meetings with Studio Manager.
- Conduct quarterly Staff Reviews and provide a detailed report on each artist on how they have developed over the quarter to include but not limited to goals, performance, development, attitude etc. The monthly information that will form the basis of the quarterly review be taken form the Studio Managers monthly report. These reviews will be done wherever possible in conjunction with HR and the report will be signed off by HR, Operations Manager and member of staff

- A similar Bi annual reviews will be conducted by HR, Operations Manager and Studio Manager which will need to be signed off by all parties including staff member
- A similar annual reviews will be conducted by Director HR, Operations Manager and Studio Manager which will need to be signed off by all parties including staff member
- Manage outsourced resource for India and UK.
- Support for major tenders or key opportunities.